
ARMY MARS TRAINING PERFORMANCE ASSESSMENT PLAN

May 2023

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release: distribution is unlimited.

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
MILITARY AUXILIARY RADIO SYSTEM
FORT HUACHUCA ARIZONA 85613-7070

This Page Left Intentionally Blank

Proponent.

The proponent for this publication is US Army NETCOM / G-3/5/7 Army Telecommunications Division (ATD) / HQ Army MARS. Send comments and recommendations directly to:

Chief, Army MARS
US Army NETCOM G3/5/7
2133 Cushing St.
Fort Huachuca AZ
85613-7070

References.

The following references apply to this manual:

1. FM 7-0 - Training Units and Leaders for Full Spectrum Operations, February 2011
2. FM 7-1 – Battle Focused Training 2003
3. ADP 7-0 - Training Units and Developing Leaders
4. ADRP 7-0 - Training Units and Developing Leaders
5. STP 11-25C13-SM-TG, Soldiers Manual and Trainers Guide Skill Levels 1, 2, 3
February 2005
6. STP 11-25U14-SM-TG, Soldiers Manual and Trainers Guide Skill Levels 1, 2, 3
January 2015

CHANGE PAGE

LIST OF EFFECTIVE PAGES

INSERT LATEST CHANGED PAGES. DESTROY SUPERSEDED PAGES

NOTE: The portion of this text affected by the changes is indicated by a vertical line of the page. Changes to illustrations are indicated by shaded or screened areas or by miniature pointing hands. Changes of issue for original and changed pages are:
ORIGINAL.....

Page
No.

Change
No.

*Zero in this column indicates an original page

- 1. RETAIN THIS NOTICE AND INSERT BEFORE TABLE OF CONTENTS.
- 2. Holders of this document will verify that page changes and additions indicated above have been entered. This notice page will be retained as a check sheet. This issuance, together with appended pages, is a separate publication. Each notice is to be retained by the stocking points until the standard is completely revised or canceled.

Table of Contents

Proponent.....	iii
References.....	iii
INTRODUCTION	2
1 MISSION ESSENTIAL TASKS.....	3
2 EXECUTION.....	4
2.1 Intent	4
2.2 Training Concept.....	4
2.3 Task Sheet	5
2.4 Pre-Requisite Skills and Abilities.....	6
2.5 Retraining	6
3 TASKS TO SUBORDINATES	7
3.1 Civilian Volunteer Leaders (CVL) and Auxiliarist Responsibilities	7
4 ADMINISTRATION	8
4.1 Transfer Training between Regions	8
4.2 Task Summary Format.....	8
4.3 Using DA Form 5164R and 5165R.....	8
APPENDIX A: DA FORM 5164-R HANDS-ON EVALUATION.....	9
APPENDIX B: DA FORM 5164-R HANDS-ON EVALUATION.....	10
APPENDIX C: DA FORM 5165-R SQUAD BOOK	11
GLOSSARY	12
Table 1. MARS Mission Essential Task List (METL) Crosswalk	3

This Page Left Intentionally Blank

Introduction

This publication is for U.S. Army MARS (AMARS) leadership, assigns responsibilities and directs the training of AMARS personnel. It replaces all previous Army MARS Training Manuals, and is superior to and supersedes all Region and State Level 1 and Level 2 training.

AM 7, *The Army MARS Training Performance Assessment Plan*, is taken from Army Field Manuals (FMs), Army Doctrine (ADRs and ADPs), and Soldier Training Publications (STPs) that detail current guidelines, training principles, and common tasks based on U.S. Army Military Occupational Specialties (MOS). AMARS is an Army organization that adopts Army doctrine.

The AM 7, establishes the standard for human performance for MARS Auxiliaries and Member Candidates (MC) and assigns responsibilities to the Civilian Volunteer Leaders (CVL) which oversee training. CVLs are comprised of the Region Directors (RD) and their subordinate leaders.

- AM 7 Skill Level 1 is the Army MARS Basic Training Course (BTC) and emphasizing skill development and the completion of tasks. Demonstrated Proficiency in Skill Level 1 tasks is required of all MCs in their first six months of membership. Army MARS members who complete Skill Level 1 earn the title “Auxiliary”.
- AM 7 Skill Level 2 is the In-service Training Program with the critical tasks for every volunteer listing the Tasks, Conditions, and Standards for proficiency. Demonstrated proficiency in Skill Level two tasks is required to renew membership after the second calendar year as an Army MARS Auxiliary.

Army Doctrine Publication (ADP) and Army Doctrine Reference Publication (ADRP) ADP 7-0 and ADRP 7-0 are the principal references for establishing the training concept. AMARS training officers should familiarize themselves with the following sections of these manuals before applying AM-7 in MARS (these references are not recommended reading for personnel who are in-training at Skill Level 1 and 2).

- The Role of Training and Leader Development
- Principles of Unit Training and Development
- Unit Training Management
- ADRP 7-0 Chapter 3 covers the Operations and Planning process.

ADP 7-0 and ADRP 7-0 are available by selecting *Army/Joint/ Multi-Service Field Manuals* at:

<https://www.usarmymars.org/resources/references-public>

1 Mission Essential Tasks

The Mission Essential Task List (METL) is a statement of the requirements that are essential to complete the missions assigned to an organization. The METL for AMARS is:

- Lead, organize and administer a diverse group of volunteers.
- Plan, conduct training, and assess individual and collective training tasks to standard in order to maintain operational readiness.
- Conduct network operations (voice/data) to support DoD missions.
- Provide temporary DSCA and HA/DR communications support as tasked by the Combatant Command (COCOM) or the Components.
- Provide training assistance to Regular Army, Reserves and National Guard.
- Coordinate community resources to maximize operational effectiveness in a variety of environmental conditions.

In addition to the METL, the Chief Army MARS (CAM) publishes an Annual Training Guidance memo that describes the training strategy, objectives and priorities. The training guidance is derived from previous rehearsals, after action reports and assessments.

Table 1 is a cross-walk between the Mission Essential Tasks (MET) at each skill level.

METL	Lead, organize and administer a diverse group of volunteers	Train to standard in order to maintain operational readiness	Conduct network operations to support DoD missions	DSCA and HA/DR	Provide training assistance to Regular Army, Reserves and National Guard	Coordinate with community resources
Skill Level 1 New Member Basic Training	Orientation	Load MSC Software Load Encryption Keys Demonstrate long distance HF radio communications.	Communicate in a Radio Net Receive and forward a message using MSC software Draft and send a USMTF message using MSC software Relay a message to a higher-level net Call a radio net	National Incident Management System independent study	Send and receive using Chat Receive and send a Voice Message	National Incident Management System independent study
Skill Level 2 In-service Training (DRAFT)	Mentor a Member Candidate	Mentor a MC Restore MSC and operating system Predict take off angle and operating frequency using VOACAP	Call a radio net 4 x. Perform minor relay station functions Perform message center functions, Consolidate strips into RRI Query remote message machine Create a response Strip	Interview Amateurs for local information	Support QRPX	Identify local Part 95/97 Radio Service organizational leaders Interview Amateurs for local information

Table 1. MARS Mission Essential Task List (METL) Crosswalk

2 Execution

Sustaining MARS is an on-going activity that requires orienting and training competent and confident civilian volunteers to maintain and expand the membership. A standardized training approach is required to provide relevant support to DoD. AMARS will organize training activities to provide this support.

Training to standard should be a simple and intuitive approach to operations with a minimum of procedural facts the MC or Auxiliarist must train and retain. Training should not be difficult and trainers or other leaders shall not attempt to increase difficulty by training MCs to a higher standard than set by AM7.

Training is a team effort and the entire AMARS organization has a role that contributes to overall readiness.

Individual Auxiliarists are the foundation of all training activity. The Auxiliarists are the subject matter experts (SME) and the principal facilitators of training.

2.1 Intent

The desired outcome of this training and performance assessment plan is to maintain competent and confident Auxiliarists who are able to provide relevant support to DoD missions.

2.2 Training Concept

Training is a team effort and the entire AMARS organization has a role that contributes to overall readiness.

- The Region is where MCs and Auxiliarists will learn to perform their individual supporting tasks.
- The Region provides oversight by assessing readiness, establishing priorities, and directing the focus of the training. The Region also trains the CVL and staff.

The AMARS Training Concept encompasses all Mission Essential Tasks (MET) across the four skill levels including the administration and leadership of the AMARS program. Skill level one and two are formally defined by task, condition and standard:

- The first skill level is the Basic Training Course, or Level 1. These are the METs a MC must demonstrate to become an Auxiliarist and take in-service training.
- The second skill level is in-service training where Auxiliarists perform METs in everyday network operations and exercises. Level 2 METs are more complex tasks required to support missions. The CVL observe Auxiliarists perform daily operations and exercises and use Form 5164R and 5165R to document the Auxiliarists performed the MET to standard. The continuous observation and evaluation of Level 2 METS by CVL ensures individual Auxiliarist can perform these METS to standard and offer opportunities for additional training assistance to maintain the standard.

2.3 Task Sheet

Each MET is represented by a Task Sheet as shown in Table 2. The Task sheet is a standardized format that describes the task, condition, and standard for each MET.

Task Number: (example)	Task Title: (example)	
Action: The Action specifies what you will do need to do in order to successfully complete the task.		
Condition: The Condition describes the learning environment – the tools which will be provided or omitted, time constraints, and the like. Think of it as the scenario in which the task is to be completed.		
Standards: The Standards provide the criteria used to measure if the task has been mastered.		
Training and Evaluation: Training and Evaluation provides the specific steps or instructions to take in order to complete or be credited for the task.		
Performance Measures (PM): Performance Measures provides reference for the trainer or mentor to evaluate whether the task has been successfully completed.	GO	NO GO
References: References list the material that will need to be references in order to successfully complete the task. Related references are also listed and may be helpful but are not required reading. Identifying the relevant doctrine, technical and field manuals for operating a military radio station enables MARS members to respond to new situations without depending on leadership to provide direction, and is a primary training objective.	Related Some references required to complete this course are sensitive in nature. This information is available through your Training Officer or Mentor. All other references are available at: http://www.usarmymars.org/resources/	
Warnings: Warnings will provide information regarding safety hazards or any specific cautions that should be taken when completing the task.		
Notes: Additional Information		

Table 2 Example Task Sheet

2.4 Pre-Requisite Skills and Abilities

The Department of the Army (DA) establishes in Army Regulation 25-6, section 3-1 certain skills and abilities to qualify for membership.

It is the responsibility of the individual to achieve these pre-requisite skills and abilities independent of any AMARS sponsored training, and prior to applying for AMARS membership. As part of the recruiting and on-boarding of prospective members, Leaders should assess the prospective member's abilities to ensure they will have the ability to become successful Auxiliaries.

2.5 Retraining

Training is a human resource action that documents a MC or Auxiliary has demonstrated a behavior or skill. This documentation helps leaders establish that personnel are trained to standard. Training and retraining documentation is essential to distinguish substandard performance due to a lack of knowledge to correctly perform the task from indifference or non-compliance with procedures.

It is essential that all Auxiliaries can perform the METs in their skill level to standard. Leaders must establish retraining for Auxiliaries who no longer perform to standard.

Retraining is a process where a leader, trainer, or mentor amplifies the performance steps required to perform a MET to standard and having the auxiliary demonstrate their ability to successfully perform the MET to standard. Once successful, the mentor/trainer documents the results on the form 5164.

When retraining, the mentor/trainer should use different instructional approaches to match a MC or Auxiliaries learning style.

Leaders use the Auxiliaries' training record and their ability to perform the METs to standard during the annual membership renewal process. Auxiliaries who are no longer able or willing to perform to standard should be considered for non-renewal once the leaders have exhausted available retraining efforts.

3 Tasks to Subordinates

The CAM delegates authority to the Region Director and subordinate leaders as the primary trainer of the general membership.

3.1 Civilian Volunteer Leaders (CVL) and Auxiliarist Responsibilities

These responsibilities are listed below.

Regions

The Region Director is responsible for ensuring effective training occurs throughout the region, including training subordinate leaders. The Region Director directs the Region Staff to:

- Ensure standards-based, performance-oriented training occurs on an ongoing basis.
- Establish the priorities for training in accordance with the CAM's Annual Training Guidance
- Ensure training is facilitated using teleconference services
- Ensures members are continuously trained, evaluated for Level 2 MET's and retraining is completed as needed.
- Ensure sufficient staff/mentors are appointed/identified to support the Region training officer to accomplish the assigned duties and responsibilities.
- Identify all Auxiliarists who qualify for annual renewal.

Trainers / Mentors

Trainers and Mentors are responsible for the training and socialization of individual Auxiliarists and MCs, including in-service skills development. Training officers and mentors:

- Conduct orientation and basic skills training for MCs
- Conduct In-Service training for all AMARS Auxiliarists
- Assess the performance and readiness of the Auxiliarists
- Identify and develop subject matter experts and mentors to facilitate the delivery of training
- Provide re-training as required to ensure MET standards are maintained

Auxiliarists

Every AMARS Auxiliarist is responsible for maintaining proficiency in the individual tasks listed in this AM. All Auxiliarists work collaboratively to achieve this objective by:

- Participating in regularly scheduled network operations
- Training in quarterly exercises, mini-exercises and in-service training sessions
- Volunteering as Mentors, Subject Matter Experts and/or for Staff and Leadership positions

All Auxiliarists continuously train to improve their skill in each task, and equally important, assist others in achieving and maintaining proficiency.

4 Administration

4.1 Transfer Training between Regions

MCs who are in the process of BTC training and who relocate to another Region retain credit for completed tasks by transferring their academic evaluation report to the new Region Director. The transferring member is responsible for ensuring the Training Officer signs off completed tasks on DA Form 5164R before leaving the Region, and forwarding that form to the new Region Director and Training Officer.

4.2 Task Summary Format

Task summaries outline the performance requirements of each critical task described in MET Skill Level 1, and 2. They provide the individual and the trainer with the information necessary to prepare, conduct, and evaluate critical task training. As a minimum, task summaries include information the individual must know and the skills that he or she must perform to standard for each task.

4.3 Using DA Form 5164R and 5165R

DA Form 5164-R, (Hands-on evaluation) and DA Form 5165-R (Squad Book) are administrative tools used to document the accomplishments of individuals who are training.

- DA 5164R is used to record the evaluation of a single individual who is working on a list of tasks. This form is particularly useful for Basic Training tasks.
- DA 5165R may be used to track the evaluation of a group of individuals who are working on tasks. This form would be useful for an In-Service training environment where several individuals are working on their tasks as a team or “squad”.

Appendix A: DA Form 5164-R Hands-On Evaluation

Level 1 – Basic Training Course

HANDS-ON EVALUATION (DA Form 5164-Rv)		DATE:
TASK TITLE		TASK NUMBER
Basic / Individual TASKS		LEVEL 1
ITEM	PERFORMANCE STEP TITLE	(CIRCLE ONE)
SL1-1	National Incident Management System	GO / NO-GO
SL1-2	Orientation	GO / NO-GO
SL1-4	MSC Software (MSC Tasks 1-1 through 1-7)	GO / NO-GO
SL1-5	Load Encryption Keys	GO / NO-GO
SL1-6	Communicate in a Radio Net (ATP 6-02.53)	GO / NO-GO
SL1-7	Receive and Send a Voice Message (FM 6-99)	GO / NO-GO
SL1-8	Send and Receive using Chat	GO / NO-GO
SL1-9	Receive and forward a message using MSC software	GO / NO-GO
SL1-10	Draft and Send a USMTF message using MSC software	GO / NO-GO
SL1-11	Relay a message to a National Network	GO / NO-GO
SL1-12	Call A Radio Net (ATP 6-02.53)	GO / NO-GO
Score a GO if the individual passes all performance measures. Score a NO-GO if the individual fails any performance measure. For a NO-GO, show what was done wrong and how to do it correctly.		
EVALUATOR'S NAME:		ORGANIZATION:
TRAINEE'S NAME:		STATUS: GO / NO-GO

Appendix B: DA Form 5164-R Hands-On Evaluation

Level 2 – In Service Training

HANDS-ON EVALUATION (DA Form 5164-Rv)		DATE:
TASK TITLE		TASK NUMBER
Intermediate Level / Individual Tasks		LEVEL 2
ITEM	PERFORMANCE STEP TITLE	(CIRCLE ONE)
SL2-1	Call the Region Net 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐	GO / NO-GO
SL2-2	Query a remote message machine, QSL messages	GO / NO-GO
SL2-3	Perform Minor Relay Station Functions	GO / NO-GO
SL2-4	Process a Request Strip	GO / NO-GO
SL2-5	Interview Amateurs for local information	GO / NO-GO
SL2-6	Create a Response Strip	GO / NO-GO
SL2-7	Support QRPX	GO / NO-GO
SL2-8	Use VOACAP to select frequency and show take off angle	GO / NO-GO
SL2-9	Mentor a new member	GO / NO-GO
SL2-10	Restore MSC and operating system from backup	GO / NO-GO
SL2-11	Perform Message Center Functions / Consolidate response strips	GO / NO-GO
SL2-12	One-Time training updates per HQ AMARS	GO / NO-GO
Candidates passing all PMs receive a GO. If the candidate does not meet any PM, demonstrate the correct procedure and describe how to do it correctly. Have the candidate perform the PMs until they achieve the standard.		
EVALUATOR'S NAME:		ORGANIZATION:
TRAINEE'S NAME:		STATUS: GO / NO-GO

GLOSSARY

ADP	Army Doctrine Publication
ADRP	Army Doctrine Reference Publication
AM	Army MARS
AMARS	Army Military Auxiliary Radio System
APAN	All Partners Access Network
BTC	Basic Training Course
CAM	Chief Army MARS
CVL	civilian volunteer leaders
DA	Department of the Army
DSCA	Defense Support of Civil Authorities
DoD	Department of Defense
DoDD	Department of Defense Directive
Etc.	and so forth
HA/DR	Humanitarian Assistance/Disaster Relief
HF	High Frequency
HQ	Headquarters
MARS	Military Auxiliary Radio System
MC	Membership Candidate
MET	Mission Essential Tasks
METL	Mission Essential Task List
MOS	Military Occupational Specialty
NETCOM	US Army Network Enterprise Technology Command
PM	Performance Measures
SL	Skill Level
SME	Subject Matter Expert
STP	Soldier Training Publication
USMTF	United States Message Text Format